

Kantonsschule im Lee Winterthur
Maturitätsarbeit HS 2025/26

Developing a playable simulation of markets and corporations

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October 17, 2025

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1 Motivation

During Economy Week (Deutsch: Wirtschaftwoche), as an exercise in *business administration*, we *played* a game, where you were the board of a company manufacturing some arbitrary product and had to make decisions to increase sales, lower cost and generally beat out your competition. For me, the aspect of being able to come up with novel management ideas and compete with your friends really hooked me into the concept. This may sound hyperbolic, but during that week I genuinely woke up excited to go to school, not to actually learn stuff (and whatever) but just to play a few more rounds and (aspirationally) completely destroy my competition.

The game we got to play during Economy Week, in my opinion, had a tantalising hook but the interface was utterly hostile to non-directed interaction: it was pretty much an excel table! Anyway, I set off to make a better, deeper version of this simulation.

"We do this not because it is easy, but because we thought it would be easy"

Not JFK.

This is the running motto of this project.

2 Goals

The main goals of this project are to make

1. A multiplayer game where you lead a company within a market
2. Have it work
3. Document what I learnt, how and why I did what I did

3 Concept and Design

The concept behind the game was originally to create a game where the company creates and runs a company that manufactures and sells a product while competing with their friends. Imagine a sort of [Civilisation](#) for digital entrepreneurs.

The most important part of the game is that you, as a player, have to balance many internal and external factors: production costs, consumer demands, labour unions, economic downturns and, most importantly, competition.

As I often do, I jumped into the coding head first, before I ever knew what I really

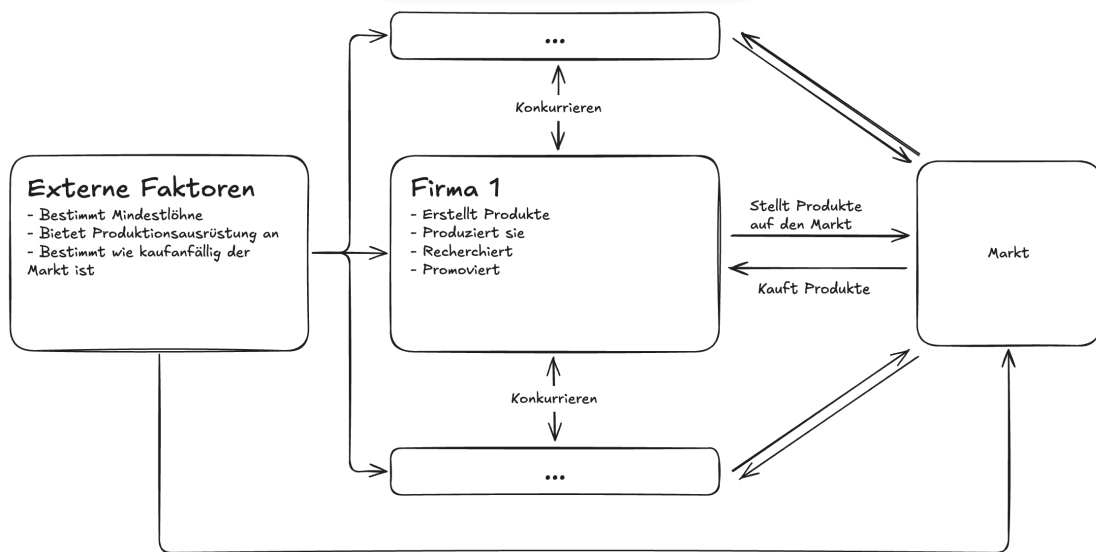


Figure 1: Diagram of factors influencing the player's decisions

wanted to make. My general idea was based around ~~copying~~ *creating an experience that felt similar* to what we had experienced during Economy Week. And since the original was just a thin skin over pretty much an Excel table, I started off by making something similar.

4 Design

The game would work in 2 phases: the *decisions phase* and the *simulation phase*.

During the decisions phase the player would set the values for various decisions like how many production machines they choose to buy. Just like the what we played during Economy Week, the interface was a thinly veiled Excel table.

After trying to "play" this for a few minutes I simply thought to myself: "This can't be fun, let alone would anyone care show this to their friends!", and so I gave myself a new blank canvas and actually tried thinking about what I wanted to make.

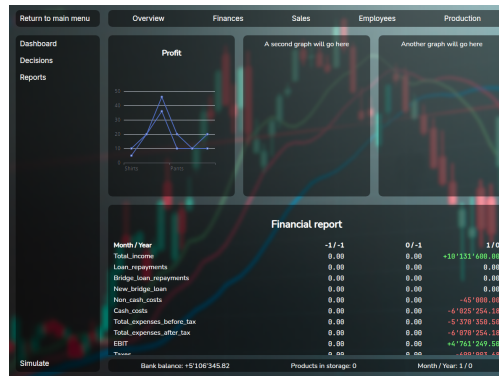


Figure 2: The first UI I made for the game

4.1 Mechanics

5 Technology

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6 Iteration

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7 Economic model

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8 Actually making it fun

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